Minutes of the
General Government Committee Meeting
Held Electronically
At 1:00 p.m. on June 8, 2020

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

Present:	Chair - Councillor	A. Khan, Chair
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Taylor Morin
		L. Bower
	Mayor	S. Collier

1. Call to Order

Chair Khan called the meeting to order at 1:00 p.m. and provided an overview of the electronic meeting format.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Adoption of Minutes

3.1 Regular Meeting

Moved by: S. Lee

That the Minutes of the regular meeting of the General Government Committee held on March 9, 2020 be adopted.

CARRIED

3.2 Closed Session

Moved by: L. Bower

That the Minutes of the Closed Session of the General Government Committee held on March 9, 2020 be adopted.

CARRIED

4. Consent Agenda

Members separated items 4.1, 4.2, 4.3, 4.4, 4.5, 4.6, 4.7, and 4.9 for discussion.

Moved by: S. Collier

That item 4.8 of the consent agenda be adopted.

CARRIED

4.1 Annual Investment Report – January 1, 2019 to December 31, 2019

Committee Members discussed the content of the report and the Town's investment activities. Sandra Serrao, Acting Director of Finance/Treasurer, discussed the Town's investment strategy within the current financial environment.

Main Motion

That the Annual Investment Report for the period January 1 to December 31, 2019 be received for information.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

That the motion be amended by adding the following clauses:

That staff be directed to report back to Ajax Council at September's GGC meeting with recommendations on investments for Ajax's long term reserves under the provisions of the Prudent Investment Standard; and

That any GIC's that mature between today and the September report not be renewed and form part of the recommendations.

CARRIED

Main Motion as Amended

Moved by: S. Collier

That the Annual Investment Report for the period January 1 to December 31, 2019 be received for information;

That staff be directed to report back to Ajax Council at September's GGC meeting with recommendations on investments for Ajax's long term reserves under the provisions of the Prudent Investment Standard; and

That any GIC's that mature between today and the September report not be renewed and form part of the recommendations.

CARRIED

4.2 **2019 Operating Budget Surplus and Net Year End Reserve Allocations**

Members of the Committee asked questions regarding clarification of the tax increment revenue, status of the review of the Financial Sustainability Plan, and opportunities to top up the stabilization reserve with any budget surplus.

S. Serrao responded to questions from the Committee and provided details on the timeline and phased approach for the Financial Sustainability Plan review.

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That the report on the 2019 Operating Budget Surplus be received for information.

2. That Council approve the total transfer of the 2019 operating surplus of $308,800 to the Stabilization Reserve

CARRIED

4.3 **Indexing of Municipal Development Charges**

Members of the Committee asked questions regarding the timeline for application approvals, and proposed increase to development charges indexing.

S. Serrao responded to questions from the Committee and provided updated information on the Region of Durham's position on increased development charges indexing.

Moved by: L. Bower

That the report on Indexing of Municipal Development Charges be received for information.

CARRIED

4.4 **Development Charge Reserve Funds - Treasurer's Annual Statement**

Members of the Committee asked questions regarding recovery plans to cover the development charges deficit.

S. Serrao responded to questions from the Committee and provided details on the process and timing of the matter.

Moved by: S. Collier

That the report "Development Charge Reserve Funds – Treasurer's Annual Statement" be received for information.

CARRIED

4.5 **2019 Cash-in-lieu of Parkland Reserve Fund - Treasurer's Annual Statement**

Members of the Committee asked questions regarding the use of the Increased Height and Density Bonusing tool provided under Section 37 of the *Planning Act.*

Geoff Romanowski, Acting Director of Planning and Development Services, responded to questions from the Committee and provided an overview of the community benefits attained from application of the Section 37 tool.

Moved by: L. Bower

That the report "2019 Cash-in-lieu of Parkland Reserve Fund - Treasurer's Annual Statement" be received for information.

CARRIED

4.6 **Codes of Conduct Review**

Members of the Committee asked questions regarding timing of the review, and notice of motion to be presented at the June 15th, 2020 Council meeting regarding proposed changes to the Procedure By-law and Council Code of Conduct, and if such changes will impact the review.

Nicole Cooper, Director of Legislative and Information Services/Clerk and Alexander Harras, Manager of Legislative Services/Deputy Clerk responded to Members' questions and noted that considerations from the notice of motion will be incorporated into the review.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

That the report titled 'Codes of Conduct Review' be received for information.

CARRIED

4.7 **Municipal Elections - Contribution Rebate Program Review**

Members of the Committee asked questions regarding contribution rebate programs in other municipalities, participation rates in the program, cost of the program, and public feedback. N. Cooper and A. Harras responded to questions from the Committee indicating that review of the program is conducted after each election. A. Harras provided details of program participation over past elections and the cost of the program.

Main Motion

That the municipal election contribution rebate program be discontinued.

Motion to Refer

Moved by: L. Bower

That the Municipal Elections – Contribution Rebate Program Review report be referred back to staff with direction to undertake public consultation before reporting back to Council.

CARRIED

RECORDED VOTE:

In Favour:	Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Tyler Morin, Mayor Collier, Councillor Bower, Regional Councillor Crawford, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Khan
Opposed:	None

4.8 **Contract Award – Supply & Delivery ~ Fleet – Repl. Snow Plows**

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That Council award the contract for two Single Axle Snow Plows, to Premier Truck Group in the amount of $663,974.44 (inclusive of all taxes).

2. That Council approve funding of $7,329.55 to be allocated to Capital Account No. 1016211 from Vehicle/Equipment Replacement Reserve.

CARRIED

4.9 **Amendment to the North Harwood Employment Property Agreement of Purchase and Sale with Grandview Children's Centre**

Members of the Committee sought clarification on the subject lands. G. Romanowski responded to questions from the Committee and indicated the timeline for the pre-consultation process is anticipated to commence this summer.

Moved by: S. Lee

That a by-law to approve an Amending Agreement of Purchase and Sale with Grandview Children's Centre for the sale of the North Harwood Property be presented to Council at its meeting of June 15, 2020.

CARRIED

5. Discussion

5.1 **Automated Speed Enforcement**

Mayor Shaun Collier led discussion and sought feedback from the Committee regarding proceeding with expedited automated speed enforcement implementation within community safety zones. Members of the Committee asked questions regarding number and location of community safety zones, the process for establishing community safety zones, costing, risks associated with expediting implementation, and implications with waiting until the Region implements its program.

G. Romanowski and John Grieve, Transportation Supervisor, responded to questions from the Committee. J. Grieve provided an overview of the process for establishing community safety zones for automated speed enforcement areas.

6. Presentations

6.1 Town of Ajax Wayfinding Strategy

Armi de Francia, Active Transportation Co-ordinator, presented an overview of the contents of the written report and the recommendations therein. A. de Francia discussed the development of the Town of Ajax Wayfinding Strategy, including navigation, methodology, site visit findings, signage types, proposed budget, and proposed wayfinding sign locations by ward.

Members of the Committee asked questions and shared comments regarding consultation with local cycling clubs and funding providers, promotion of cycling tourism, font size of signage, Smart Cities partnerships, twinning of the waterfront trail, protected bike lanes, and reconnection of the Duffin Trail, south of Bayly Street.

A. de Francia and G. Romanowski responded to questions from the Committee.

Moved by: L. Bower

1) That the report entitled “Town of Ajax Wayfinding Strategy” be received for information.

2) That Council approve the Wayfinding Strategy for use in the deployment of wayfinding signage around Town.

CARRIED

Mayor Collier exited the meeting at 2:56 p.m.

6.2 2020 Age-Friendly Ajax Community Plan

Tracey Vaughan, Director of Recreation, Culture and Community Development, thanked staff and members of the Age-Friendly Ajax Steering Committee for their work on the Age-Friendly Ajax Community Plan. Robert Gruber, Manager of Community & Cultural Development, presented an overview of the contents of the written report and the recommendations therein. R. Gruber discussed the definition of an Age-Friendly Community, eight elements of age-friendly classification, community engagement in developing the Plan, the vision statement, goals for each element and next steps, including launch of the Plan and implementation.

Members of the Committee asked questions regarding expansion of seniors’ centres, opportunities for intergenerational programming, lessons learned as a result of the pandemic, and the possible distribution of the Plan in multiple languages. T. Vaughan and R. Gruber responded to questions from the Committee.

Moved by: J. Dies

1. That the 2020 Age-Friendly Ajax Community Plan (AFACP) be endorsed by Council, in principle; and,

2. That any projects identified therein for future years be brought forward to Council for consideration as part of the annual budget process.

CARRIED

Mayor Collier re-entered the Meeting at 3:25 p.m.

Closed Session (3:25 p.m.)

7. Authority to Hold a Closed Session

Moved by: L. Bower

That the Committee convene to a Closed Session pursuant to Sections 239 (2) (b, c) of the *Municipal Act, 2001,* as amended, to discuss personal matters about identifiable individuals, including municipal or local board employees and a matter pertaining to the proposed or pending acquisition or disposition of land by the municipality or local board.

CARRIED

7.1 **Harwood Avenue Midtown Cross-Section**

7.2 **Confidential Personnel Matters**

Open Meeting (5:20 p.m.)

Ratify Actions Taken In Closed Session

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

That all directions approved in the Closed Session be ratified.

CARRIED

8. Adjournment (5:21 p.m.)

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the June 8, 2020 meeting of the General Government Committee be adjourned.

CARRIED

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Chair

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D-Clerk